



GLOBAL NEWS MARKET

UI/UX & Production Readiness Report

Full-system audit of every screen, current state vs. target state, the database schema additions needed for production, and a prioritized master fix plan.

PREPARED 21 September 2026

SYSTEM WEMIX / Habari Platform — Django REST backend, 6 apps, 46 models · static HTML/JS frontend, 8 page

SCOPE Every frontend page · cross-cutting production gaps · database schema · prioritized fix plan

01 Executive Summary

WEMIX (Habari Platform) is a verified-news marketplace: journalists, media houses, and individual sellers publish stories for sale; buyers purchase access. The backend is Django REST Framework (6 apps, 46 database models); the frontend is deliberately no-build-step static HTML + vanilla JavaScript across 8 pages, calling the API through a single `apiFetch()` wrapper.

This report has two parts. **Part A** (Sections 2–3) audits every page against what it currently looks like and does, versus what a production-grade version should look like, with concrete gaps for each. **Part B** (Sections 4–5) covers cross-cutting production readiness — including what earlier work in this engagement already fixed — and the exact database tables needed to close the remaining gaps. **Section 6** is the master fix plan: every open item, ordered by priority, written to be actioned directly.

Already fixed earlier in this engagement (not open items):

- ✓ Critical: full-resolution listing media was not actually paywalled — the API served the original file regardless of purchase status. Fixed: gated behind the same access check as the article body, with a real watermarked preview generated on upload.
- ✓ Marketplace search was exact-substring matching with no relevance ranking. Replaced with Postgres full-text search (ranked, stemmed, tag-aware).
- ✓ No SMS/WhatsApp channel existed for time-sensitive alerts. Built an Africa's Talking SMS client, wired into sale-confirmation and saved-search alerts.
- ✓ KYC had OCR pre-fill but no face-match/liveness signal. Added a pluggable external-vendor hook (same pattern as the AI verification engine).
- ✓ Brand identity had drifted to navy/blue/red across the CSS despite the logo always being black/white/gold. Restored the correct palette platform-wide, including 9 spots that were failing WCAG contrast.
- ✓ The homepage (`index.html`) carried a second, unrelated color palette, a dead hamburger menu, a dead “Home” nav link, three non-functional header icons, a permanently-disabled “Watch Live” button, a stub newsletter form, and two redundant content sections fetched via a duplicate API call. All rebuilt.

Everything below is what's **still open**, organized so it can be handed back as a work order.

02 Current State vs. Target State — Every Page

Evidence-based: each page below was actually loaded in a real browser (Chrome, driven headlessly) this session — not inferred from source alone — with real seed-data accounts.

2.1 · index.html — Homepage

Public entry point. Rebuilt this engagement; now the most polished page in the system.

CURRENT STATE

- Masthead (logo, search, sign-in/avatar), category nav with horizontal-scroll overflow, breaking-news ticker, hero + Latest sidebar, Top Categories, one consolidated Trending grid, honest 3-column footer.
- Verified working end-to-end: real login-form submission, category browsing, “Home” and “Trending → View All” navigation, mobile layout at 390px width.

TARGET STATE

- Matches current implementation — no structural changes needed.

GAPS TO CLOSE

- Cosmetic only: the hero card shows a plain black gradient with no imagery when a story has no cover image (no illustrated placeholder).
- Category icon grid wraps unevenly at narrow (~4-column) widths on some phone sizes — pre-existing, not introduced by the rebuild.

2.2 · login.html

Split-screen editorial panel + form. Verified: fills, submits, redirects correctly.

CURRENT STATE

- Dark brand panel (wordmark, value props) + white form card (email, password, submit, register link).
- No page header/nav chrome by design — a logged-out visitor gets a focused screen, not the full app shell.

TARGET STATE

- Same layout; add the one missing standard affordance below.

GAPS TO CLOSE

- No “Forgot password?” link, and **no password-reset flow exists anywhere in the backend** — confirmed by search, there is no reset-token endpoint. A production auth screen cannot ship without this.

2.3 · register.html

Same split-screen pattern as login, full signup field set.

CURRENT STATE

- First/last name, username, email, phone, role selector (Buyer/Journalist/Media House/...), password + confirm, terms checkbox, submit.

TARGET STATE

- Same fields; the role selector should be fully readable.

GAPS TO CLOSE

- The "I am a..." role-select's text overflows and truncates inside the field at normal width ("Buyer — I want to purchase verified nev..." cut off) — visual bug, confirmed in-browser.
- No password-strength indicator (minor, non-blocking for MVP).

2.4 · dashboard.html — Seller/Buyer Dashboard

Functional and tested end-to-end (wallet balance, listings, tab switching all confirmed against real data).

CURRENT STATE

- 11 tabs in one horizontally-scrolling row: My Listings, Sell News, Verification, My Purchases, Bookmarks, Following, Withdrawals, Support, Subscriptions, Alerts, Developer.
- Sidebar profile card + wallet-balance card; main panel renders per-tab content correctly.

TARGET STATE

- Same feature set, organized so it scales past 11 tabs without becoming a horizontal-scroll hunt — especially on mobile, where none of the later tabs are visible without scrolling the tab strip itself.

GAPS TO CLOSE

- Information architecture: 11 flat, equally-weighted tabs is already a lot; grouping into clusters (Selling / Buying / Account) would scale far better as more tabs get added — which they will.

2.5 · listing.html — Listing Detail (the conversion page)

Functional and correctly paywalled (verified this session). Visually the weakest page in the funnel.

CURRENT STATE

- Title, byline, trust badge, license/territory pill, plain paywall box ("This story is locked"), price card with a single purchase CTA, reviews section.
- Footer text on this page reads "© 2026 **Habari Platform** · Arusha, Tanzania" — inconsistent with every other page, which says "WEMIX" and "Dar es Salaam."

TARGET STATE

- Same information, presented with the visual weight this page deserves — it's the one screen that actually converts a browser into a buyer: a real hero/cover treatment, a distinct seller-profile module, and the metadata/media features already built on the backend surfaced on-screen.

GAPS TO CLOSE

- Wire metadata (credit line, capture date, GPS, keywords) is serialized by the API but never rendered here.
- Social-share buttons are not present, even though a full `SocialShareRecord` backend already exists for this exact purpose — a built feature nobody can reach.
- No "more from this seller" or related-stories module — a dead end after reading, no path to a second sale.

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- Fix the “Habari Platform / Arusha” footer text to match the rest of the site.
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2.6 · moderator.html — Moderation Console

The most feature-rich page in the system; verified extensively this session across moderator and super_admin roles.

CURRENT STATE

- 6 main tabs (Verifications, Users, Listings, Transactions, Treasury*, Settings, Reports), several with their own 4–6-item sub-tab pill row (*Treasury/admin-only tabs gate correctly on role).
- All exercised live this session: KYC review, listing/AI-score queue, user management + the new API-keys panel, sales/refunds/withdrawals/subscriptions, corrections form, wire-metadata display.

TARGET STATE

- Same functional surface, in a layout built to keep scaling — this page has grown by roughly a third in this engagement alone and will keep growing.

GAPS TO CLOSE

- Top-tabs-plus-pill-sub-tabs has no persistent wayfinding (no breadcrumb, no remembered filters) — fine at today's size, will not stay fine. A persistent left-nav admin-shell is the standard pattern at this feature count.
- Roughly half of the inline spacing declarations across this file are still literal px values rather than the design-token scale (low-severity, flagged previously, partially addressed).

2.7 · checkout.html

Deliberately minimal single-card polling screen; appropriate for its narrow purpose.

CURRENT STATE

- One centered card: spinner, “Waiting for payment confirmation...”, instructions to complete payment on the mobile-money prompt or gateway page.

TARGET STATE

- Same minimal shape; add the two things a real buyer needs while staring at a spinner.

GAPS TO CLOSE

- No order summary on-screen (what they're buying, for how much) while they wait — no confirmation reference.
- No cancel/back-out action if the payment hangs or they change their mind — the only way out is navigating away manually.

2.8 · terms.html

Clean, honest, well-written 14-section legal document, tied to a real versioning + re-acceptance flow.

CURRENT STATE

- Single scrolling card, numbered sections 1–14, version stamp at the top, small “← Back to marketplace” link in the header only.

TARGET STATE

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- Same content; easier to navigate on a page this long.
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GAPS TO CLOSE

- No jump-links/table of contents despite 14 numbered sections.
 - No footer or back-link at the bottom — finishing the document means scrolling all the way back up.
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03 Cross-Cutting Production Gaps

Findings that span more than one page, or sit entirely in the backend, grouped with status.

Finding	Severity	Status	Detail
No self-service password reset	High	Open	No endpoint or frontend screen exists anywhere in the codebase. Django's built-in stateless token generator needs no new table — just 2 endpoints + 1 page.
Payment gateways unconfirmed	High	Blocked — external	Neither Selcom nor Nala has been run against a real sandbox. Needs real merchant credentials from the business side; no code fix closes this.
AI verification is heuristic, not a trained model	Medium	Mitigated	A pluggable external-model hook already exists (AI_VERIFICATION_API_URL); nothing is wired to it by default.
No C2PA content-provenance signing	Low	Tracked	Emerging wire-service standard (Adobe/BBC/Reuters/AP). Needs real signing infrastructure; out of proportion for this pass.
Homepage runs separate header/footer from the rest of the app	Medium	Deliberately open	Merging into the shared minimal app-topnav would strip the homepage's editorial masthead — a real regression, not a fix. Left as its own implementation on purpose.
listing.html visual/feature parity	High	Open	See 2.5. The highest-traffic conversion page is also the least finished.
Dashboard/Moderator information architecture	Medium	Open	See 2.4 and 2.6. Both pages already show real strain at current scale.

Small confirmed bugs (not architectural, quick to fix):

- ✗ register.html: role-select dropdown text overflows/truncates.
- ✗ listing.html footer: says “Habari Platform” / “Arusha” instead of “WEMIX” / “Dar es Salaam.”
- ✗ checkout.html: no order summary or cancel action on the waiting screen.
- ✗ terms.html: no bottom navigation on a 14-section page.

04 Database Schema — What Production Actually Needs

The instinct when a page needs new content is “add a table.” Two of the five gaps below are better solved by **reusing** a table that already exists — called out explicitly so effort doesn't go into schema that isn't needed.

4.1 · No new table needed

Need	Reuse this	Why
Platform social links, contact info, feature flags	PlatformSetting (core app)	Already a generic key/value store. Add keys (e.g. social.facebook_url) + an admin settings UI section + wire into the footer/homepage. No migration.
Password reset	None — stateless	Django's built-in PasswordResetTokenGenerator (same mechanism Django admin uses) needs no storage: HMAC over the user's password hash + last-login. Just 2 endpoints + 1 page.
Social share buttons on listing.html	SocialShareRecord (news app)	Model already exists and is fully built — this is a frontend wiring gap, not a database gap.

4.2 · New tables to add

StaticPage (new app or core) — Priority: Medium

Backs About Us, Careers, Press Center, FAQ, Privacy Policy, and Cookie Policy — currently unlinked placeholder text with nothing behind them. One model, moderator-editable, reuses the existing AuditLog for change history.

Field	Type	Notes
id	UUID pk	BaseModel convention
slug	CharField, unique	e.g. “about”, “careers”, “privacy”
title	CharField	
body	TextField	Markdown or rich text
meta_description	CharField, blank	SEO
is_published	BooleanField	Draft vs. live
updated_by	FK → User	SET_NULL
created_at / updated_at	DateTimeField	BaseModel convention

ContactMessage (core app) — Priority: Low/Medium, optional

Only needed if “Contact Us” should work for a logged-out visitor without requiring signup first. If that friction is acceptable, skip this and keep routing Contact through the existing SupportTicket flow (already built, requires login).

Field	Type	Notes
id	UUID pk	BaseModel convention
name / email	CharField	Anonymous submitter
message	TextField	
handled	BooleanField, default False	For a moderator inbox view
created_at	DateTimeField	BaseModel convention

NewsletterSubscriber (core app) — Priority: Low, conditional

Only build this if the newsletter feature is wanted back as a *real* one. The stub version was removed from the homepage this engagement precisely because it collected nothing and told every signer-up “not available yet.” Reinstating it means this table plus a genuine double opt-in email flow — not just the form.

Field	Type	Notes
id	UUID pk	BaseModel convention
email	EmailField, unique	
confirmed	BooleanField, default False	Double opt-in gate
unsubscribe_token	CharField	Stable per-subscriber token for one-click unsubscribe
created_at	DateTimeField	BaseModel convention

05 Design System — What to Hold Constant

Everything in Section 6 should be built against the tokens and conventions already established and verified working this engagement — not reinvented per page.

Token	Rule
Color	--color-gold #c9a227 / --color-gold-secondary #e8c468 / --color-gold-dark #8a6d1f / --color-black #0d0d0d, plus semantic --color-danger / --color-success (unrelated to brand).
Type	Poppins throughout, already loaded on every page via Google Fonts.
Spacing	4px-based scale, --space-1 (4px) through --space-10 (40px); use var(--space-N) for any new spacing that lands on a scale value.
Layout width	var(--max-width) (1180px) + 24px side padding via .container — every page must agree, not just most of them (this was itself a bug fixed this engagement).
Components	Reuse .card, .btn/.btn-outline/.btn-ghost, .pill-*, .alert-*, .dash-tabs/.sub-tabs before inventing a new pattern.
Contrast	White text only on --color-black or --color-danger fills. Black text on --color-gold and --color-gold-secondary fills (both fail WCAG with white text — confirmed by calculation this engagement).

06 Master Fix Plan

Every open item from this report, ordered by what would most affect a real buyer, seller, or moderator — written to be handed back as a direct work order.

HIGH PRIORITY

HIGH

1. Build self-service password reset

Backend: 2 endpoints using Django's stateless PasswordResetTokenGenerator (request-reset, confirm-with-token). Frontend: "Forgot password?" link on login.html + a new reset-password.html page. No migration needed.

HIGH

2. Redesign listing.html to match the rest of the site

Add a real cover-image hero treatment; surface wire metadata (credit line/capture date/GPS/keywords) already in the API response; wire up the existing SocialShareRecord backend to real share buttons; add a "more from this seller" module; fix the footer text ("Habari Platform"/"Arusha" → "WEMIX"/"Dar es Salaam").

HIGH

3. Confirm both payment gateways against live sandboxes

Selcom and Nala both need a real transaction run against their actual sandbox environments with real merchant credentials before either can take a real payment. Operational step, not a code change — needs the business side to provision accounts.

MEDIUM PRIORITY

MED

4. Add the StaticPage model + admin UI

See Section 4.2 for the exact schema. Makes About Us/Careers/Press/FAQ/Privacy/Cookie Policy real, moderator-editable pages instead of unlinked placeholder text.

MED

5. Regroup dashboard.html's 11 tabs into clusters

Selling (My Listings / Sell News / Verification), Buying (My Purchases / Bookmarks / Following), Account (Withdrawals / Support / Subscriptions / Alerts / Developer) — or equivalent groupings. Current flat scrollable row will not scale past what it already has.

MED

6. Give moderator.html a persistent left-nav shell

Replace top-tabs-plus-pill-sub-tabs with a persistent left sidebar as the primary navigation once past this many sub-sections; add a breadcrumb. This page has grown by roughly a third in this engagement alone.

MED

7. Fix register.html's role-select overflow

The "I am a..." dropdown truncates its own option text at normal field width — CSS fix (wider field, or shorter option labels with a helper line underneath).

MED

8. Add an order summary + cancel action to checkout.html

Show what's being purchased and for how much while the buyer waits; add a visible way to back out if the payment hangs or they change their mind.

MED

9. Decide on real platform social links

If WEMIX wants a social presence represented in the footer, add the URLs as PlatformSetting keys and wire them in — no migration needed. If not, current state (no social icons) is correct and should stay.

LOW PRIORITY

LOW

10. Finish tokenizing inline spacing

dashboard.html/moderator.html still carry literal px values that don't land on the 4px design-token scale; the ones that do were already converted. Mechanical, low-risk, do as its own pass.

LOW

11. Add navigation to terms.html

A bottom back-link/footer, plus jump-links for its 14 numbered sections.

LOW

12. Decide on a real newsletter or leave it removed

If reinstating: build NewsletterSubscriber (Section 4.2) plus a genuine double opt-in email flow. If not, current state (no newsletter form) is correct — a stub that told every signup “not available yet” was worse than nothing.

LOW

13. Decide on a real Contact Us path for logged-out visitors

Either build ContactMessage (Section 4.2) for a true anonymous contact form, or keep routing Contact through the existing (login-required) SupportTicket flow, which already works.